## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** poor transport to the village | Buses were slow, so the magazine reached the village late. |
| 2 | **(a)** amused and doubtful | Teaching someone so old seemed a joke, but she began. |
| 3 | **(c)** spiritual tradition | Sages and truth show spiritual heritage. |
| 4 | **(c)** Kashi Yatre | She waited for each part of Kashi Yatre. |
| 5 | **(d)** determined and humble | She worked hard and honoured her young teacher. |
| 6 | **(a)** an appeal to the reader | He invites everyone to praise the land. |
| 7 | **(b)** an orphan girl's marriage | She decided another's happiness mattered more than her pilgrimage. |
| 8 | **(d)** teacher | A teacher instructs. |
| 9 | **(b)** pride in the motherland's greatness | A tribute to land, rivers, wisdom. |
| 10 | **(b)** girls of her time were not sent to school | Girls' schooling was ignored in her childhood. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | She felt helpless (1) because she depended on others to read the serial she loved (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | It means succeeded very well (1). For example, Meera passed her test with flying colours (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | A line repeated at intervals (1). It stresses the poem's main idea and adds rhythm (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | She spent them on an orphan girl's wedding (1) instead of going on a pilgrimage (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | She waited eagerly for every episode (1). Since she could not read, she needed others to read it aloud (1). Her love for the story pushed her to learn (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | They shared love and trust (1). The narrator supported her dream (1). The grandmother respected her as teacher and granddaughter (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | The tone is proud and joyful (1). The poet uses words of praise and a call to sing (1). Repetition adds confidence (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** They began with the alphabet (1). The narrator taught her after school hours (1). The grandmother did her lessons and homework carefully (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | It tells us what happens: a granddaughter teaches her grandmother (1). The word 'taught' reverses the usual roles (1). It hints at the theme of learning at any age (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** The narrator said that her grandmother was learning fast (1). Present tense 'is learning' changes to past 'was learning' (1). 'Grandmother' stays as a noun and takes 'her' (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Hardworking and determined (1). Loves stories and wants independence (1). Humble: learns from a child (1). Respectful of teachers (1). Overall: an inspiring example of lifelong learning (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Mountains: strong guardians (1). Rivers: life-givers (1). Heritage: wisdom of sages (1). Refrain: peerless land (1). Pride and devotion as the mood (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Her wish after missing the serial (1). Start of lessons with the alphabet (1). Daily practice and homework (1). Meeting the target by Dassara (1). Touching the teacher's feet (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Refrain for emphasis (1). Personification of the land and nature (1). Imagery of mountains and rivers (1). Alliteration or rhythm for musical effect (1). Together they add pride and beauty (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Writing that **Sudha Murty** is the grandmother, or that the grandmother is the author. The narrator is the granddaughter (the author) who teaches her grandmother, who began learning at about **sixty-two**.

- Giving the wrong reason for the grandmother's illiteracy. In her childhood girls were not sent to school; do not say she was lazy or had no time.
- Missing the theme: the story is about **learning at any age** and the respect a teacher earns, not just 'a grandmother who reads a serial'. Name the serial (*Kashi Yatre*) and the goal (reading a novel) when asked for details.
- In 'Bharat Our Land', calling the poem sad or critical. Its mood is proud and celebratory; naming only 'rhyme' for devices instead of **refrain, personification (mountains guard her) and imagery**.
- Tense slips such as *'She learn to read at sixty-two'*; the narrative needs the simple past (**learnt**). Also confusing the teacher and pupil roles when writing the summary.
- Copying lines of the lesson as the answer. Write 2-mark answers as a point plus a reason (1 + 1), in your own words, and quote only the key phrase.

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

# ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

## SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(d)** Subramania Bharati | A Tamil poet and patriot. |
| 2 | **(a)** The grandmother said that she would read the novel. | Will becomes would; I becomes she. |
| 3 | **(b)** could not act without someone's help | Dependence on others was her pain. |
| 4 | **(d)** ode | Bharat Our Land praises the motherland. |
| 5 | **(a)** She learnt to read at sixty-two. | Simple past is needed. |
| 6 | **(b)** Saraswati Puja during Dassara | She wanted to read before the festival. |
| 7 | **(c)** personification | Mountains are given a human action. |
| 8 | **(c)** independent | Independent = self-reliant. |
| 9 | **(d)** sixty-two | She began at sixty-two. |
| 10 | **(c)** life-giving | They bring water for crops. |

## SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Reading gives independence (1) and links a person with stories and the world (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Deep pride and love (1) with an invitation to all to praise her glory (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | She wished to read a novel by Saraswati Puja during Dassara (1), so she began lessons soon after (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Refrain (1) and personification or imagery (1). | 1+1 |

## SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | It gave her a clear goal (1). It showed her strong will to be independent (1). She met the goal by hard work (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Mountains protect and stand for strength (1). Rivers bring water and life (1). Together they show the land's natural wealth (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | had read (1) or could read (1). 'By Dassara' marks a point before which the action was complete (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** It reversed the usual custom, with an elder bowing to a youngster (1). It showed that knowledge deserves respect (1). It showed the grandmother's humility and gratitude (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Ancient wisdom and holy books (1). Sages and heroes of the past (1). The poet is proud of this tradition (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** The grandmother was determined to read her novel (1). She was humble enough to learn from a child (1). Both words describe her character (1). | 1+1+1 |

## SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Introduction: age is no barrier (1). The grandmother started at sixty-two (1). She worked hard and succeeded (1). Others can be inspired by her (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Theme: praise of the motherland (1). Poet and form: an ode (1). Images of nature and wisdom (1). Devices and tone (1). Your personal response (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Lifelong learning (1). Respect for a teacher of any age (1). Value of literacy and independence (1). Love between generations (1). Importance of girls' education (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Format with address, date, salutation (1). Mention the wish to read (1). Describe the lessons and your teacher (1). Express your joy (1). Close with advice to learn (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Writing that **Sudha Murty** is the grandmother, or that the grandmother is the author. The narrator is the granddaughter (the author) who teaches her grandmother, who began learning at about **sixty-two**.
- Giving the wrong reason for the grandmother's illiteracy. In her childhood girls were not sent to school; do not say she was lazy or had no time.

- Missing the theme: the story is about **learning at any age** and the respect a teacher earns, not just 'a grandmother who reads a serial'. Name the serial (*Kashi Yatre*) and the goal (reading a novel) when asked for details.
- In 'Bharat Our Land', calling the poem sad or critical. Its mood is proud and celebratory; naming only 'rhyme' for devices instead of **refrain, personification (mountains guard her) and imagery**.
- Tense slips such as *'She learn to read at sixty-two'*; the narrative needs the simple past (**learnt**). Also confusing the teacher and pupil roles when writing the summary.
- Copying lines of the lesson as the answer. Write 2-mark answers as a point plus a reason (1 + 1), in your own words, and quote only the key phrase.

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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# ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 1: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

## SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** the granddaughter, in first person | The narrator is the granddaughter. |
| 2 | **(d)** respected a teacher whatever her age | A teacher deserves respect at any age. |
| 3 | **(b)** refrain | It stresses the main idea. |
| 4 | **(a)** patience | She taught with patience. |
| 5 | **(a)** did exceptionally well | Flying colours = great success. |
| 6 | **(d)** proud and celebratory | It sings the glory of the land. |
| 7 | **(d)** unable to read and write | Il- means not. |
| 8 | **(b)** It can begin at any age | A sixty-two-year-old learner succeeded. |
| 9 | **(c)** without equal | Peerless = no one equal. |
| 10 | **(d)** real family memory | It is a memoir-style narrative. |

## SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | She learnt at an advanced age (1) with hard work and humility (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | She touched her granddaughter's feet (1) to show respect to her teacher (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Subramania Bharati wrote it (1). It is an ode praising the motherland (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Peerless means without equal (1). The poet calls the land peerless (1). | 1+1 |

## SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Many girls were not sent to school (1). Families gave little importance to their learning (1). The grandmother's regret shows what was lost (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | It repeats the poet's message of praise (1). It creates a song-like rhythm (1). It makes the poem easy to remember (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | It makes pictures of mountains, rivers and sages in the mind (1). It makes the land feel alive (1). It strengthens the poet's pride (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** The grandmother was sixty-two when she began (1). She worked until she could read (1). She reached her target before the festival (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | The poet lists her mountains, rivers and wisdom (1). Each is great and old (1). So he claims that no land is like her (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** It praises the land and her people (1). It calls everyone to join in praise (1). It is full of love for the nation (1). | 1+1+1 |

## SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Date and salutation (1). Describe the festival and the reading (1). Describe her surprise at the gesture (1). Her feelings of pride and humility (1). Closing thought (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Gives independence (1). Brings access to stories and the world (1). Boosts confidence and dignity (1). Helps meet goals (1). Society gains when all learn (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | At first she was amused and doubtful (1). She began with patience (1). She was impressed by the effort (1). At the end she felt proud and moved (1). She learnt respect for learners (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Story: touching feet shows respect for knowledge (1). Poem: praise shows respect for the land (1). Both involve gratitude (1). Both are shown through action or song (1). Conclusion: respect gives meaning to life (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

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